BRAIN TRAINING

Brain training is the activity of improving your cognitive abilities. This can be as simple as playing a puzzle platformer, or using flash cards for memorisation. In recent years, there have been a number of apps available that provide brain training exercises, with different mini games for the various cognitive processes. Some of the apps improve a wide range of cognitive abilities, including spatial perception, response time, attention, language, retention and hand eye coordination. Other apps focus on one thing, and do that thing very well, such as Eidetic for memory. The app does not simply test your memory skills, but also gives tips on how to remember better, based on one simple technique for doing so – that of repetition. One of the simplest ways to improve your vocabulary is to use Google's Word Coach, just search for the phrase in Chrome and it should start up.

Brain training apps:

- Lumosity
- Peak
- Cognifit
- Happify
- Eidetic
- Plague Inc
- Wizard

The science of brain training is still new, and there are a lot of conflicting studies on the efficacy of brain training apps or techniques. The studies are conflicting because the fundamental hypothesis about brain training, that exercising your brain improves your cognitive abilities has not yet been proven or disproven. There is evidence to suggest that the apps only make the person better at using the app, skills that do not translate well into the real world. However, enclosed in the box on the left are names of apps developed in collaboration with psychologists and neurologists.

You don't need apps to exercise your brain. One exercise for memory is to remember three distinct aspects of a person, such as their footwear, their posture, and their face shape. For improving your math skills, go back to basics and memorise the multiplication tables, as well as the additions of different fractions. There are all kinds of mathematical exercises that you can do instead of daydreaming. Learning a new language and composing music have both shown to be beneficial for a range of cognitive abilities, and both of these are useful skills in themselves.

TEAMWORK AND COLLABORATION

There is a slight, but important distinction between teamwork and collaboration. In teamwork, two or more parties work towards the same end goal, by distributing tasks between themselves. In collaboration, all the parties involved work together to accomplish each of those tasks. Collaboration takes teamwork to the next level, and can at times involve your clients in the process as well. Most modern work environments are extremely collaborative in nature, and this aspect is increasingly being built into the tools used in professional environments. Even in work environments where there is a clear distinction in the tasks assigned to people, it helps in knowing what the other people in your team are working on, and what they are doing at any given point in time, which just improves the overall performance of the team. Say, if a team is making a video game, and there is a UX developer, a 3D artist, a programmer, and a marketer in the team, then it is better that these people can communicate with each other instead of the team manager acting as an intermediary between all of them. In such an environment, it is very possible that the 3D artist will learn more about programming and the programmer learns more about 3D modelling, which stands to benefit both the project and their individual careers. This is far better

Use these apps to collaborate better:

- Slack
- Deputy
- Yammer
- TimeDoctor
- Trello
- Basecamp
- Asana
- Google Docs